

Knicks Pull Off the Biggest Comeback in NBA Finals History!

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Have you ever seen a team look totally beaten, only to fight back and win? That's exactly what happened Wednesday night at Madison Square Garden. The New York Knicks were losing by 29 points to the San Antonio Spurs in Game 4 of the NBA **Finals**. It seemed like the game was over. But the Knicks didn't give up. They made the biggest **comeback** in **Finals** history and won 107-106! OG Anunoby **tipped** in a missed shot with just 1.2 seconds left to seal the victory. The Knicks now lead the **series** 3-1 and are just one win away from their first championship in over 50 years. Jalen Brunson led the charge with 36 points, and Anunoby added 33. The Spurs had a huge first half, led by Victor Wembanyama's 24 points and 13 **rebounds**. But in the second half, the Knicks' defense **clamped** down, and the Spurs' shots stopped falling. The crowd went wild, singing "Don't Stop Believin'" after the game. No team had ever come back from more than 24 points down in a **Finals** game before. The Knicks beat that record by five points! Game 5 is Saturday in San Antonio. Can the Knicks finish the job?

Word Treasure

comeback -- when a team that is losing by a lot of points turns the game around to win

Finals -- the last series of games to decide the champion

rebounds -- when a player grabs the ball after a missed shot

series -- a set of games where the first team to win 4 games wins the championship

clamped -- in sports, to guard very tightly and stop the other team from scoring

tipped -- to lightly touch a ball, often to redirect a shot

Background you need

The New York Knicks haven't won an NBA championship since 1973, making their fans very eager for a win.

Madison Square Garden, where the game took place, is one of the most famous sports arenas in the world, often called 'The Mecca of Basketball'.

No team had ever come back from more than 24 points down in an NBA Finals game before this night.

Break it down

WHO: The New York Knicks, with star players Jalen Brunson and OG Anunoby

WHAT: They made the biggest comeback in NBA Finals history, winning 107-106 after being down 29 points

WHERE: At Madison Square Garden in New York City

WHY: Because their defense tightened in the second half and they never gave up

Why it matters

This shows that no matter how far behind you feel, hard work and believing in yourself can still lead to an amazing success.

Test what you remember

1. What was the final score of Game 4?
 - (A) 107-106
 - (B) 110-107
 - (C) 107-100
 - (D) 106-104
2. Who tipped in the winning shot?
 - (A) OG Anunoby
 - (B) Jalen Brunson
 - (C) Victor Wembanyama
 - (D) A Spurs player
3. How many points were the Knicks losing by before their comeback?
 - (A) 24
 - (B) 29
 - (C) 36
 - (D) 33
4. What song did the crowd sing after the game?
 - (A) 'Don't Stop Believin'
 - (B) 'We Are the Champions'
 - (C) 'New York, New York'
 - (D) 'Eye of the Tiger'
5. Where will Game 5 be played?
 - (A) New York
 - (B) San Antonio
 - (C) Los Angeles
 - (D) Chicago
6. Which Spurs player had 24 points and 13 rebounds?
 - (A) Victor Wembanyama
 - (B) Jalen Brunson
 - (C) OG Anunoby
 - (D) Paddy Pimblett

Answer key (try the quiz first!): 1: A 2: A 3: B 4: A 5: B 6: A

1. **Knicks fans:** They are overjoyed that their team made history and is on the brink of a first championship in over 50 years.
2. **Spurs fans:** They are disappointed their team couldn't hold a huge lead and now face a very difficult path to win the series.
3. **Basketball historians:** They are amazed by the record-breaking comeback and are excited to see if the Knicks can finally secure the title.

MY THOUGHTS (at least 20 words):